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TUESDAY, OCTOBER 14, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

CTA looks to raise fares in face of budget gap

Would be first ticket price hike since 2018

By Talia Soglin
Chicago Tribune

Chicagoans should expect to pay more for city trains and buses next year as the CTA looks to raise fares in the face of a looming fiscal crisis.

If the fare hikes of 25 cents per ride are approved by the agency's board, it will be the first time the CTA has raised ticket prices since 2018.

The fare increases come as the CTA has warned it could have to cut bus and train service by as much as 25% starting in the middle of next year.

"The service cuts we may be forced to make beginning in 2026 will be the single-largest transit service cut in the modern history of the Chicago Transit Authority," the agency's acting president, Nora Leerhsen, warned earlier this month.

Like peer transit agencies around the country, the CTA is facing a fiscal crisis caused by the depletion of one-time federal pandemic aid — and ridership numbers that simply haven't returned to pre-2020 levels.

The price hikes are laid out in the agency's proposed 2026 budget, which was released Monday. All in all, the agency is proposing an operating budget worth about \$2.09 billion next year, assuming it receives no new funding from state lawmakers.

The proposed fare increases will come whether or not there's new funding.

Starting Feb. 1, the cost of a single CTA bus trip would jump

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Madigan reports to federal prison

Former House speaker serving sentence in West Virginia

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Former House Speaker Michael Madigan reported to a low-security federal prison camp in West Virginia on Monday to begin serving his 7½-year sentence on corruption charges, an ignominious end for a man who for decades was considered the most powerful politician in the state.

Madigan, 83, arrived Monday morning at the facility in Morgantown, which has an all-male population of about 180 inmates, according to an intake official at the prison.

At Madigan's sentencing in June, his lawyers asked that he serve his time at the medium-security facility in Terre Haute, Indiana, which is only about 180 miles south of Chicago. The Morgantown facility, meanwhile, is about an eight-hour drive. It was unclear if that request had changed or if the U.S. Bureau of Prisons made the decision.

Madigan's attorneys were not immediately available for comment.

The West Virginia facility has at least one ironic Chicago connection — it's where former City Clerk James Laski, the onetime 23rd Ward alderman and Madigan political acolyte, served his two-year sentence for his 2006 bribery conviction.

Laski's wife, Kathleen, came up repeatedly during Madigan's trial as an example of Common-

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Evyatar David, center, a hostage released from the Gaza Strip, sits in a van with his family at Rabin Medical Center in Petah Tikva, Israel, on Monday. AMIT ELKAYAM/THE NEW YORK TIMES

Hostages, prisoners freed in crucial step

Complex issues in Israel-Hamas deal remain unresolved



Palestinian prisoners released by Israel wave from a bus as they arrive at Nasser Hospital in Khan Younis, in the southern Gaza, on Monday. SAHER ALGHORRA/THE NEW YORK TIMES

By Wafaa Shurafa, Samy Magdy and Melanie Lidman
Associated Press

DEIR AL-BALAH, Gaza Strip — Israel and Hamas moved ahead on a key first step of the tenuous Gaza ceasefire agreement on Monday by freeing hostages and prisoners, raising hopes that the U.S.-brokered deal might lead to a permanent end to the two-year war that ravaged the Palestinian territory.

But thornier issues such as whether Hamas will disarm and who will govern Gaza — and the question of Palestinian statehood — remain unresolved, highlighting the fragility of an agreement that for now only pauses the deadliest conflict in the history of Israel and the Palestinians.

For Israelis, the release of the 20 remaining living hostages brought elation and a sense of closure to a war many felt they were forced into by Hamas, although many pledged to fight on for the return of deceased hostages still in Gaza. But with the

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Ill. looks at limiting federal immigration agents

Broadview mayor shrinks designated area for protests

By Dan Petrella
Chicago Tribune

With the Trump administration's ramped-up immigration enforcement efforts continuing to rile the Chicago area, officials in west suburban Broadview took steps on Monday to insulate residents from flare-ups between protesters and police as state lawmakers returning

to Springfield this week look to strengthen legal safeguards for people swept up in "Operation Midway Blitz."

With the Democratic-controlled legislature reconvening Tuesday for its scheduled six-day fall session, Illinois House Speaker Emanuel "Chris" Welch said lawmakers will explore whether the state can restrict U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents and other immigration agency personnel from taking people

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Transportation workers guide a barricade along the residential side of South 25th Street near the U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement holding facility in Broadview on Monday. STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

ICE tickets man for not carrying papers

Under federal law, registered foreign nationals must carry proof of registration with them at all times. But prior to a second Trump administration, it was rarely enforced. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

Northwestern professor shares Nobel

A Northwestern University professor has been awarded the Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences for his historical studies on sustained economic growth through technological progress. **Business**

